South-Eastern Myanmar seek to position themselves as — and are often perceived to be — protectors" (Schissler 2016, p. 11). Indeed, traditional modes of patron-client relations can be said to include the use of villagers as labourers, porters, fighters, and as a source of revenue (Taylor 2009). Multiple armed groups in this region tax the populations they dominate, and commit human rights violations, force labour and conscript troops, and take or destroy food, crops, and land (Jolliffe 2014; South 2012). The power of local militia extends across networks of politicians, military officers, and businesses. These networks provide militia leaders access to formal and informal economies. As Yue (this volume) and Callahan (2003) show, there are a variety of political accommodations for militia at sub-national levels, including business concessions and other incentives.

The need for multiple relationships to mitigate the violations of one or more actors is crucial for community survival. Hence, patron-client relations may feature multiple overlapping networks between competing armed actors, businesses, or influential persons. Relationships also extend to a range of respected faith-based representatives, and CSOs who may themselves enter into relationships with the parties to conflict and communities as a means of minimizing conflict and maximizing community protection.

## RESPONDING TO CHRONIC INSECURITY WITH COMMUNITY PROTECTION STRATEGIES

Jose and Medie characterize community protection as "activities undertaken during armed conflict (international or non-international) to preserve physical integrity in which the primary decision maker is a civilian or group of civilians" (2015, p. 516). It aims to protect the community against immediate, direct threats to physical integrity imposed by belligerents or traditional protection actors.

In the case of Myanmar, South et al. (2010) categorize self-protection into three strategies of containment, avoidance, and confrontation. These strategies encompass activities like establishing hiding sites in preparation for expected displacement, hiding food stores in the forest, monitoring troop movements, and employing advanced warning systems to alert villagers to approaching army patrols, retrieving food and other supplies left behind at villages during flight, cultivating covert agricultural fields, sharing